



MALKIA
INITIATIVE



STRATEGIC PLAN

2025 - 2029

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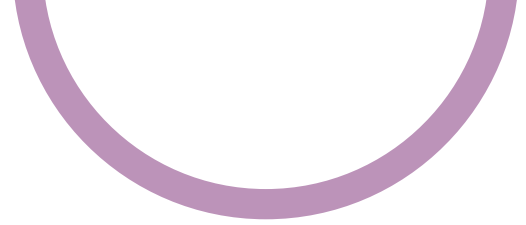


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Foreword.



Jedidah Lemaron

Founder and Executive Director
The Malkia Initiative

As Executive Director of The Malkia Initiative, I am pleased to introduce our Strategic Plan for 2025-2029. This plan results from a collective effort informed by our experiences, the needs of the communities we serve, and a vision for the future. It represents not only the roadmap for our organization but also a commitment to deepening our impact and delivering transformative change.

At the heart of our work is an unwavering dedication to girls-centered programming and the empowerment of young people. By investing in girls and young people, we are transforming individual lives and driving systemic change in our communities. This strategic plan outlines our commitment to creating safe, inclusive, and empowering spaces where girls can thrive, lead, and contribute to their fullest potential. We are determined to ensure every girl can access opportunities that foster her growth, resilience, and leadership.

In today's rapidly evolving landscape, we recognize the need to remain adaptive, bold, and innovative in our approach. This strategy outlines our priorities, reflects on our achievements, and, most importantly, aligns our values with clear, actionable goals. At the core of our work is a firm belief in the power of collaboration, the importance of evidence-based interventions, and the pursuit of sustainable solutions that uplift and empower Girls and Young People, particularly those who have historically been underserved.

I extend my deepest gratitude to our partners, stakeholders, and dedicated team, whose tireless work has made this plan possible. Together, we are charting a course toward a brighter and more equitable future.

With this strategic plan, we reaffirm our unwavering commitment to crowning every African girl while preparing for the opportunities and challenges ahead. As we embark on this next chapter, I invite you to join us in this journey of hope, resilience, and impact.

Executive Summary

The Malkia Initiative is a youth-led, women-led community organization dedicated to empowering adolescent girls and young women in rural pastoralist regions of Kenya. We are powered by the **Vision** to crown every African girl with the skills, confidence, and opportunities to lead and inspire. Guided by the **Mission** to catalyze community change to amplify the agency, voice, and choice for every adolescent Girl and Youth, this Strategic Plan 2025-2029 aligns itself with the national priorities as espoused in Kenya's Vision 2030 and the global Sustainable Development Goals (SDG 3, 4, 5 & 17). This strategic plan is informed by external and internal factors, leading to its organization into three main pillars:

1. Girl Centred program and advocacy,
2. Evidence building and sharing and
3. Resourcing for HER (The Malkia Initiative and the Girl).

Under this, the Strategic Plan 2025-2027 underpins four strategic areas around which its implementation will be organized: Adolescent Youth Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (AYSRHR); Evidence generation to inform decision-making; Strategic Partnerships for organizational growth and Organizational Growth and Sustainability.

Its operationalization is anchored on these strategic objectives: 1. To promote the uptake of sexual and reproductive health services for AGYP in all their diversities by 2029 as measured by increased access to quality healthcare services; 2. To establish a knowledge Management hub for collation and capacity strengthening adolescent girls/ young people-led research and evidence generation by 2029; 3. To enhance the Malkia Initiative's profile and reputation to attract and sustain strategic partners through effective communication and visibility by 2029 and 4. To enhance the Malkia Initiative's effectiveness and efficiency to deliver on its Mission by strengthening the internal systems and structures by 2029. This Strategic Plan 2025-2029 shall be the fulcrum of the Malkia Initiative, which The Malkia Initiative will take a broad step in expanding her scope and scaling the heights of partnerships and programming beyond Kenya. The Malkia Initiative is committed to creating a future where every African girl can realize her potential. By focusing on education, health, and leadership, we aim to break down the barriers that hold young women back and build a more equitable society.

Acknowledgement

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to all those who have contributed to developing the Malkia Initiative Strategic Plan 2025-2029. This plan is a testament to the collective efforts and unwavering commitment of our dedicated team, partners, and supporters.

First and foremost, we thank our board members and staff for their tireless work and visionary leadership. Your dedication to empowering women and girls in Kajiado and across pastoral Kenya has been instrumental in shaping this strategic direction.

We are deeply grateful to our partners, donors, and volunteers whose generous support and collaboration have made our initiatives possible. Your belief in our Mission and your contributions have been vital in driving our progress and impact.

Special thanks to the community members and stakeholders who participated in our consultations and provided invaluable insights. Your voices and experiences have enriched this plan and ensured it is grounded in the realities and needs of those we serve.

Lastly, we acknowledge the resilience and strength of the women and girls at the heart of the Malkia Initiative. Your courage and determination inspire us daily to strive for a future where every girl can achieve her fullest potential.

Together, we look forward to successfully implementing this strategic plan and continuing our journey toward gender equity and empowerment.

LIST OF ACRONYMS

AGYW	Adolescent Girls & Young Women
AGYP	Adolescent Girls & Young People
CBO	Community-Based Organization
CSE	Comprehensive Sexuality Education
UNAIDS	United Nations Programme on HIV/AIDS
PWUD	People Who Use Drugs
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats
SRHR	Sexual Reproductive Health Rights

1. INTRODUCTION

The Malkia Initiative is proud to present its Strategic Plan for 2025-2029, a roadmap designed to guide our efforts in empowering adolescent girls and young women in rural pastoralist communities of Kajiado, Kenya. This plan builds on our commitment to creating a future where every girl can achieve her fullest potential, free from systemic and cultural barriers.

Over the next three years, we aim to deepen our impact through targeted programs focusing on gender equity, adolescent and youth sexual reproductive health and rights, foundational numeracy and literacy, and Education for Girls. Our approach is rooted in the principles of mentorship, authenticity, leadership, knowledge, inclusion, and aspiration. By centering our programs around the voices and needs of the girls and

young people we serve, we ensure that our initiatives are relevant and transformative.

This strategic plan results from extensive consultations with our stakeholders, including community members, partners, donors, and the girls themselves. Their insights and experiences have been invaluable in shaping our direction and priorities. We are committed to fostering an environment where every girl feels valued, supported, and empowered to make informed decisions about her life and future.

As we embark on this journey, we invite you to join us in our Mission to equip, engage, and empower the next generation of leaders. Together, we can create a world where every girl is crowned with the opportunity to thrive.

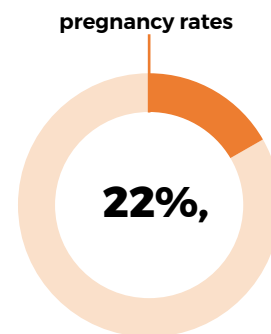
1.1 Organizational Background

The Malkia Initiative, taking its name from the Swahili word for “Queen,” is on a mission to crown every African girl. The Malkia Initiative is a youth-led, women-led community organization founded in 2015 and officially registered as a Community-Based Organization in October 2016 (registration number KJD/HUD CBO/0242). We work in Rural pastoralist Kajiado to unleash the boundless potential of adolescent girls and the youth by equipping them with skills and agency to influence change in their lives and communities because systemic

and cultural barriers continue to leave them disenfranchised.

The Malkia Initiative operates in a deeply patriarchal and misogynistic setting within the indigenous Maasai community. Here, girls and women are often marginalized, their significance reduced to mere conduits for marriage. Girls as young as nine years undergo the traumatic ordeal of Female Genital Mutilation (FGM), a harmful tradition deemed a rite of passage, whose prevalence stands at 24% in Kajiado as per the KDHS 2020 report. Consequently, they are thrust

into marriage prematurely and frequently encounter teenage pregnancies. Kajiado, ranking third among Kenyan counties in teenage pregnancy rates at 22%, also bears the highest number of new HIV infections among adolescents aged 10-14. These formidable challenges severely hinder their access to quality education. Instead of being nurtured as individuals with boundless potential, they are groomed primarily for the role of wives.



1.2 Whom We Exist for:

Namunyak:

Namunyak is a 15-year-old Maasai girl from Kajiado who became a mother at a young age. At 16, she was married off to a much older man, but the marriage quickly fell apart when he discovered that she already had a child, her two-year-old daughter, Naishorua. Now living back with her parents, Namunyak faces immense challenges in caring for her daughter while navigating the expectations of the Maasai culture and traditions.

Despite the hardships, Namunyak remains resilient and committed to her family. Her life is a balancing act of embracing Maasai customs and pursuing her dreams of a better future. She is driven by the desire to give her daughter an education and opportunities she never had while still grappling with societal pressures and her own identity. Namunyak's journey embodies the struggles and aspirations of many girls supported by The Malkia Initiative.

Sanaipei:

Sanaipei was married off at the age of 10 to a 62-year-old man and endured a brutal and abusive marriage. She became pregnant at 12 and gave birth to her daughter, Zawadi, after nearly miscarrying due to violence. At 17, Sanaipei has rebuilt her life with the support of The Malkia Initiative, which helped her return to school and pursue vocational training in cosmetology. She now runs her own salon and is determined to protect her daughter from the hardships she faced, prioritizing Zawadi's education and well-being. Despite her struggles, Sanaipei finds hope in her daughter and is dedicated to supporting her future.

1.2 Organizational Principles

Vision Statement



Vision Statement

A Crown For Every
African Girl



Mission Statement

Catalyzing community change to amplify
the agency, voice, and choice for every
adolescent Girl and Youth

The Malkia Initiative, therefore, envisions a future with the following realities for Namunyak and Sanaipei;

- Where power resides in their hands,
- Where they have the freedom to choose their own futures and define their destiny,
- Where they are able to flourish in a safe and just community and society at large.

1.2.2 Core Values

Innate Potential: At the Malkia Initiative, we believe in the unique potential of every girl and young woman. Our Mission is to nurture this by providing opportunities, resources, and support, empowering them to explore creativity, build confidence, and become community leaders, driving positive change and innovation.

Collaboration: we value collaboration as a cornerstone of our Mission. By working together with communities, partners, and stakeholders, we create a supportive network that empowers girls and young women. Through collective effort, we drive sustainable change and foster an environment of mutual growth and success.

Resilience is at the heart of the Malkia Initiative, which aims to empower young women to overcome cultural and social barriers. By fostering persistence and adaptability, the initiative helps them achieve their full potential, ensuring their inclusion in social and economic spheres despite challenges.

Openness: This is predicated upon a robust ethical standing that believes in taking responsibility for our actions, demonstrated through our insistence on being forthright as the true avenue of building genuine relationships on trust.

1.2.3 The Malkia Initiative Manifesto

Malkia recognizes the interconnectedness of the issues that African girls face and thus seeks to act as a stepping-stone organization that nurtures the next generation of adolescent girls and young women to lead, inspire, and drive positive change in their communities.

(M)entorship — Guided by a belief in the transformative power of guidance, wisdom-sharing, and community, The Malkia Initiative provides mentorship opportunities to raise a generation of girls who lead, inspire, and uplift.

(A)uthenticity — The Malkia Initiative's work is anchored in the genuine stories, struggles, and strengths of African girls. Malkia, therefore, advocates for the authentic representation and celebration of their diverse identities.

(L)eadership — We understand that leadership is not just about positions but the need to make a difference. The Malkia Initiative invests in nurturing the leadership capabilities of every African girl, enabling them to drive change in their communities.

(K)nowledge — Knowledge is Power. Through education, skills training, and empowerment programs, Malkia strives to equip every girl with the tools she needs to shape her destiny.

(I)nclusion — The Malkia Initiative champions the idea that every African girl deserves a seat at the table regardless of her background. The work of The Malkia Initiative is committed to creating inclusive environments where their voices are amplified and heard.

(A)spiration — The Malkia Initiative encourages dreams, ambitions, and aspirations. We stand as a support system for African girls to dream big, aim high, and soar higher.

2 CONTEXT ANALYSIS

The context in which The Malkia Initiative operates is complex and changing rapidly, influencing our work and therefore has an important bearing for our strategic direction in the coming years.

2.1 Political context

2.1.1 Political environment and instabilities

Kenya is politically stable, save for the occasional agitation by the young generation, popularly referred to as the GenZ revolution, which is also fizzling out. The political environment in Kenya plays a pivotal role in shaping the strategic planning of The Malkia Initiative. Government policies on gender equality, education, and girls, women, and youth empowerment directly influence the scope and effectiveness of our programs. Political stability and support from local leaders will be crucial for successfully implementing initiatives to empower adolescent girls and young people. However, political challenges such as policy changes, bureaucratic hurdles, and cultural resistance can impact the organization's strategic goals. The next general election shall be held in August 2027, and from experience, the political campaign period always slows down activities, especially those that have a dependency on political leadership and goodwill.

2.1.2 Positive change in government's attitude towards NGOs and SDGs

In Kenya, there is a significant buy-in by the government to leverage and work with community-based organizations, non-governmental organizations, and international organizations. With the rise in needs among different sectors in Kenya, the various government Ministries have increased their synergy in working with the different organizations toward achieving all sustainable development goals. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (SDGs) adopted in 2015 at the United Nations embodies the development blueprint for the world. For Kenya, the SDGs Agenda is significant given its pivotal role during the Open Working Group that guided the transition from Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) to the adopted 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Notably, there is synergy between the SDGs and Kenya's own Vision 2030 – with similar deadlines and development aspirations.

2.1.3 The trend toward adolescent girls and young people's Meaningful Engagement

For adolescent girls and young people, meaningful participation and engagement in Kenya is increasingly vital as the country's population continues to grow. According to the World Bank, Kenya's population of 49.7 million people is projected to reach more than 63 million by 2035. This population boom is mainly due to a high birth rate combined with increased life expectancy. As a result, the proportion of the population aged 15-24 years old is expected to grow from 17.9% in 2020 to 19.4% in 2035. In order to ensure that this young population is well-equipped to contribute to the Kenyan economy and society, they must be meaningfully engaged. The Kenyan government has recently established the National Youth

Policy 2020-2030 to ensure this happens. This policy aims to empower young people to become active and responsible citizens while providing them with the tools to participate in the country's economic and social development. The policy outlines several key strategies to achieve this, including increasing access to education and skills training, creating more job opportunities, and increasing youth participation in decision-making. Additionally, the government has launched initiatives such as the Women Enterprise Development Fund and Youth Enterprise Fund, which provide grants and loans to young entrepreneurs [women and young people].

2.2 Economic context

2.2.1 Economic decline due to COVID-19

Kenya's economy has shown remarkable resilience in the aftermath of the COVID-19 pandemic. Despite the initial shock, the country's GDP growth rebounded to 5% in 2021, driven by a strong recovery in the services sector. This growth trajectory continued into 2022 through 2024, with projections indicating a steady performance around 4.9% annually. However, the pandemic exacerbated existing challenges, such as increased poverty and depleted household and public financial buffers. The economic

recovery has been uneven, with sectors like agriculture facing setbacks due to adverse weather conditions. Overall, Kenya's economic outlook remains positive, supported by diversified growth sources and sound economic policies

2.2.2 Rising unemployment, poverty and inequality

Kenya is grappling with significant challenges related to rising unemployment, poverty, and inequality.

Despite some economic growth, the benefits have not been evenly distributed, leading to a widening gap between the wealthy and the poor. High youth unemployment remains a critical issue, exacerbated by limited job opportunities and a growing labor force. Additionally, the COVID-19 pandemic reversed many of the gains made in poverty reduction, with many Kenyans still struggling to access basic services. The situation is further complicated by external factors such as global economic shocks and climate change, which continue to impact the country's economic stability.

2.3 Sociocultural context

2.3.1 Social tensions in families

In Kenya, families are often experiencing tensions arising from generational and cultural shifts. As younger generations increasingly adopt modern values and lifestyles, conflicts emerge with older family members who hold traditional views. Issues such as education, employment, and gender roles are becoming common sources of friction. For instance, the push for gender equality and women's empowerment challenges long-standing patriarchal norms, leading to disagreements. Economic pressures and urbanization also contribute to these tensions as families navigate changing social dynamics and expectations. Despite these challenges, many families are finding ways to balance tradition with progress, fostering dialogue and mutual understanding.

2.3.2 Discrimination of Persons with Disability & HIV

Stigmatization of persons with disabilities and or living with HIV in Kenya continues

to be a significant issue, with people facing discrimination and exclusion owing to the negative perception of disability that is pervasive in the country. Studies have reported that persons with disabilities in Kenya experience a range of stigma-related issues, including being subjected to name-calling, being denied access to services, being isolated from family and community, and being denied the opportunity to participate in activities. Social stigma is a critical barrier to the full inclusion and participation of persons with disabilities in society. According to a survey conducted in 2019 by the Kenya National Bureau of Statistics, almost two-thirds (62.4%) of persons with disabilities reported facing discrimination due to their disability. The same study found that persons with disabilities are more likely to experience stigma and discrimination from family members, friends, and the general public than from healthcare professionals. A 2017 report by the National Council for Persons with Disabilities (NCPWD) revealed that persons with disabilities face multiple challenges in terms of their educational

attainment, access to employment and health services, and ability to access the justice system. The report also highlighted the challenges of social stigma, with persons with disabilities often facing discrimination and exclusion.

2.3.3 Improved healthcare, access not yet widespread

The government intends to improve the accessibility and quality of healthcare services, just like the legal and educational infrastructure, according to the Kenya Vision 2030. The government is adopting a new Social Health Insurance Fund (SHIF) that is seen as a game changer in actualizing the Universal

Health Coverage (UHC). The need is high since almost one million Kenyans are pushed to poverty every year because of healthcare expenses and the accessibility to medical insurance for the lowest social classes is still very low and worse since the pandemic. The intentions are there, but the government is in a wait-and-see situation as monumental challenges still face the sector, e.g., shortage of medical equipment, insufficient coverage for operations and medicines, and disrupting strikes of hospital staff who did not receive their salaries. Facing the economic decline in the coming years, this might become even more challenging due to shifting government priorities.

2.4 Technological context

2.4.1 Increase in speed and opportunities, but the widening gap

The main technological developments in mobile technology, internet access and machine learning continue with increasing speed. In addition, COVID-19 augmented digital tools and remote working. These fast developments do widen the gap regarding digital literacy and access between rural and urban areas and lower and higher social classes. The new technology also offers opportunities in the work of NGO's, including The Malkia Initiative.

2.5 Environmental context

2.5.1 Growing awareness, alarming effects

The awareness for sustainability and social development is growing. In 2017 the Ministry of Devolution and Planning introduced the 'Implementation of the agenda 2030 for sustainable development in Kenya'. The Kenya Vision 2030 adopts the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG's) from the United Nations and developed a roadmap for implementation. Since 2017 plastic bags are banned in the country, but there are still no laws limiting single-use plastic products. Unfortunately, the effects of climate change are increasing rapidly, and Kenya experiencing challenges in water scarcity, food security,

climate refugees, and pandemics. The economic shocks as result of natural disasters and pandemics influence the most vulnerable, our beneficiaries, the hardest.

2.6 Legal context

2.6.1 Positive governmental developments and protection to vulnerable populations

Kenya has seen several positive governmental developments and protection measures for vulnerable populations in recent years. In 2018, the government launched its first ever National Social Protection Policy, which aims to provide a safety net for the most vulnerable in society and reduce the impact of poverty and inequality. The policy seeks to increase access to social protection services for all citizens, including those with disabilities, elderly persons, pregnant women, children, and the unemployed. The government

has also introduced measures to protect vulnerable women and girls. In 2013, the government passed the Sexual Offences Act, which seeks to protect women and girls from sexual violence. The Act includes provisions for the prosecution of perpetrators of sexual violence, as well as measures to support survivors. Additionally, the government launched the National Gender and Equality Commission in 2017, which seeks to promote gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls.

2.7 The Process of Developing The Malkia Initiative Strategy

The process used in the development of the Malkia Initiative Strategy is one that exemplified engagement at all levels, from funders to the community served, including Friends of The Malkia Initiative. This has been in recognition that developing a strategy of this magnitude with the fortitude to close out the gap as mentioned in the statistics shared above is required to comprehensively capture the aspirations, needs, and interests of the stakeholders involved. Within this process, The Malkia Initiative sought

the stakeholders' thoughts, reflections, and insights derived through scheduled virtual and physical consultations. This process has therefore been deeply rooted in intentional listening, co-creation, and a commitment to centering the voices and experiences of the personas identified. The personas, in this case being Sanaipei and Namunyak, who represent the adolescent girls and young women for whom the Malkia Initiative was born.

2.8 SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
• Youth and Women Leadership: The organization is led by youth and women, which ensures that the programs are relevant and resonate with the target demographic • Community-Centric Approach: Focuses on empowering adolescent girls and young women in rural pastoralist communities and those left far behind, addressing specific local needs • Comprehensive Programs: Offers a range of programs including education, sexual reproductive health, and rights, which holistically support the development of girls • Strong Guiding Principles: Emphasizes mentorship, authenticity, leadership, knowledge, inclusion, and aspiration • Largely focusing on adolescent girls-We have niched ourselves to empower adolescent girls and young people whose are the largest constituency in the world	• Resource Constraints: As a non-profit, it may face challenges in securing consistent funding and resources to sustain and expand its programs • Geographical Limitations: Currently focused on Kajiado, which may limit its impact to a specific region • Cultural Barriers: Working in rural areas with deep-rooted cultural practices can pose challenges in changing mindsets and achieving long-term impact
Opportunities	Threats
• Expansion Potential: There is potential to expand programs to other regions facing similar challenges • Partnerships and Collaborations: Opportunities to partner with other organizations, both local and international, to enhance resource availability and program reach • Localization: Leverage on Global for localization of development AID • Advocacy and Awareness: Increasing global focus on gender equality and women's rights can help in garnering more support and visibility for their cause • Digital transition: MI will leverage on the increased access to smart phones, internet and other dital tools to advance its impact	• Funding Uncertainty: Reliance on donations and grants can be unpredictable, affecting program continuity • Political and Economic Instability: Changes in political or economic conditions can impact funding and operational capabilities • Cultural Resistance: Persistent cultural resistance to change, especially regarding gender roles and education, can hinder progress • Unhealthy competition: Sometimes NGOs engage in a cutthroat competition for the limited resources thus employing underhand tactics to edge others • Confusion with another organization's branding named Malkia Foundation based in Vihiga county

3 THE MALKIA INITIATIVE STRATEGIC DIRECTION

As a youth & women-led community organization, Malkia Initiative is dedicated to empowering adolescent girls and young women in rural pastoralist Kajiado, Kenya. We therefore envisage to organize our work in three key pillars within the stated strategic period. These pillars are upon which the Malkia pathway to A Crown for Every African Girl is built. This will guide Malkia Initiative to better structure its programs, develop its learning agendas, and align its resources, both for their internal work and for the work designed for and with Namunyak and Sanapei.

The Pillar	What It Entails	How It Will Be Done
Programmatic Pillar: Girl Centered Programming and Advocacy	This pillar highlights Malkia Initiative's efforts to empower girls, engage communities, partner with stakeholders like Namunyak and Sanapei, and position itself as an insights hub and thought leader	This pillar focuses on Adolescent Youth Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (AYSRHR), Gender Equality, and Education for Girls. It aligns Malkia Initiative's programs with these themes while allowing for exploration and innovation beyond current focus areas.
Evidence Generation Pillar: Building Evidence and Sharing	The purpose of this pillar is to ensure that Malkia Initiative is positioned to be an insights hub and thought leader.	This pillar ensures Malkia Initiative periodically releases thought pieces and knowledge products, institutionalizes an arm for knowledge development, and adds value to learning agendas. It focuses on empowering adolescent girls and young women, including storytelling for knowledge sharing with relevant actors
Resource Mobilization Pillar: Resourcing For Malkia and For Her	Malkia Initiative ensures resources are mobilized and managed for two focuses: Sanapei and Namunyak (Her) and The Malkia Initiative	The Malkia Initiative's resource mobilization framework guides resource allocation, making resourcing a key pillar to support programmatic areas and evidence-building. It also ensures funds act as catalytic capital for program areas Malkia Initiative supports but cannot directly deliver.

3.1 Implementation Plan

This section presents a roadmap that outlines the pillars, strategies, resources, and timeline needed to achieve the SP 2025-2029 specific objectives. It includes defining Strategies, activities, assigning tasks, setting timelines, and monitoring progress to ensure successful execution and alignment with the overall strategy. The Malkia Initiative has identified four strategic areas under the three pillars to guide its organizational operations for the period 2025 – 2029.

Pillar one: Girl Centered Programming and Advocacy

This pillar highlights Malkia Initiative's efforts to empower girls, engage communities, partner with stakeholders like Namunyak and Sanaipei, and position itself as an insights hub and thought leader. This pillar focuses on Adolescent Youth Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (AYSRHR), Gender Equality, and Education for Girls. It aligns Malkia Initiative's programs with these themes while allowing for exploration and innovation beyond current focus areas.

3.1.1 Strategic Area 1: Adolescent Youth Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (AYSRHR)

The Constitution of Kenya 2010 provides every Kenyan with a right to the highest attainable standard of health with access to emergency treatment when necessary and emphasizes the right of access to quality health services by all including children, persons with disabilities, minorities, and marginalized groups as well as the elderly. The Malkia Initiative intends to enhance sexual reproductive health services the adolescent girls and young people in all their diversities through promoting access to SRH information & services, provision of dignity kits, and availability of safe spaces.

Strategic Objective: To promote the uptake of sexual and reproductive health services for AGYP in all their diversities by 2029 as measured by increased access to quality healthcare services.

Strategic Area	Strategies/ Initiatives	Expected Change (Outcomes)	Activities/Tasks	Cost Estimate (USD)	Timeline	Responsible
Adolescent Girls and young people Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (AYSRHR)	Sexual and Reproductive Health information and Services	Improved access & up-take of SRHR services	✓ Develop IEC materials on SRH ✓ Disseminate IEC materials to the community and public in the areas of operation ✓ Campaign and Awareness creation ✓ Use of digital platforms for adolescent girls to access. ✓ Linkages to reproductive healthcare services (like providing a referral network through a directory for instance). ✓ Promote Comprehensive Sexuality Education-Enhance policy and legal frameworks ✓ Providing support systems for girls like the peer support groups ✓ Creating safe physical and virtual spaces- Malkia Pods	450,000	2025-2029 Bi-annually	Programs Manager
	Menstrual Health and Hygiene	Retention and increase of adolescent girls in schools	✓ Mobilize funds and distribute sanitary towels and dignity kits to adolescent girls to promote menstrual health and hygiene ✓ Conduct mentorship sessions on menstrual health ✓ Hold quarterly mentorship events for AGYP in all their diversities	300,000	Quarterly	Programs Manager
	Promote Gender Equality	All individuals, regardless of gender, have equal opportunities, rights, and access to resources	✓ Campaign against violence against women and girls-Strengthen legal & policy framework ✓ Survivor support and rehabilitation ✓ Promote Gender Justice-Legal reform and advocacy; Economic empowerment of women & Girls; Leadership Development and Political Participation ✓ Elimination of harmful gender norms- Community Dialogue and Cultural Engagement; Education and School-Based Interventions; Mentorship and Role Modeling ✓ Mentorship4Girls[M4G]	300,000	Monthly Ongoing basis Quarterly	Programs Manager
	Promote Education For Girls	All girls, regardless of their socio-economic background, are enrolled in school and complete their education	✓ Transition and Retention of Young and Adolescent Girls in School- Holistic Support Programs; Community Engagement and Cultural Sensitization; Strengthening School Infrastructure and Support Services ✓ Access to Mentorship for Namunyak and Sanaipei- Establishing Peer and Professional Mentorship Networks; Integrating Technology in Mentorship; Building a Supportive Community Network	350,000	Monthly Ongoing basis Ongoing basis	Programs Manager
Sub Total				1,440,000		

Pillar Two: Building Evidence and Sharing

The purpose of this pillar is to ensure that Malkia Initiative is positioned to be an insights hub and thought leader. This pillar ensures Malkia Initiative periodically releases thought pieces and knowledge products, institutionalizes an arm for knowledge development, and adds value to learning agendas. It focuses on empowering adolescent girls and young people, including storytelling for knowledge sharing with relevant actors

3.1.2 Strategic Area 2: Evidence generation to inform decision making

This strategic area will utilize Knowledge management (KM) as a tool for systematically processing, capturing, organizing, sharing, and effectively using knowledge within the organization. It will involve creating a knowledge base where information especially from adolescent girls and young people collated and stored for ease of access and for them to tell their stories. It's envisaged this information will facilitate better decision-making and operational efficiency.

Strategic Objective: To establish a knowledge Management hub for collation and capacity strengthening adolescent girls/ young people-led research and evidence generation by 2029.

Strategic Area	Strategies/Initiatives	Expected Change(Outcomes)	Activities/Tasks	Cost Estimate (USD)	Timeline	Responsible
Evidence generation to inform decision making	✓ Adolescent girls and young people with increased capacity in storytelling, research & evidence generation ✓ Quality evidence products like, case studies, journals, articles, paper, human stories of impact, blogs, abstracts etc ✓ Knowledge Management Hub ✓ Stakeholder engagement with the evidence generated	Quality adolescent-girls/ young people-led knowledge generated products influencing advocacy, decision-making, and policy development at national, regional and global levels.	✓ Capacity Building the girls on knowledge generation ✓ Research and Evaluation ✓ Establish a knowledge hub for Sanaipei and Namunyak issues ✓ Stakeholder Engagement ✓ Advocacy and Communication ✓ Monitoring and Feedback Mechanisms	250,000	2025-2029 Monthly Monthly Quarterly	Programs Manager
	Stakeholder Engagement	Strengthened Partnerships& relationships.	✓ Celebration of national and international days (International Day of the Girl Child, International Women's Day, 16 Days of Activism,) ✓ Participation in policy development and review forums (meetings and TWGs) ✓ Contribution to shadow reports and resolutions ✓ Engage duty bearers on gender and rights dialogues at county and sub-county levels ✓ Conduct research and presentations on inequality-AGYP in their diversity	50,000	Annually Bi-annual Quarterly Annually	Executive Director/ Program Manager
Sub Total				300,000		

Pillar 3: Resourcing For Her and Malkia Initiative

The Malkia Initiative will ensure resources are mobilized and managed for two focuses: Sanaipei and Namunyak (Her) and The Malkia Initiative. The Malkia Initiative's resource mobilization framework guides resource allocation, making resourcing a key pillar to support programmatic areas and evidence-building. It also ensures funds act as catalytic capital for program areas The Malkia Initiative supports but cannot directly deliver.

3.1.3 Strategic Area 3: Strategic Partnerships for organizational growth

The Malkia Initiative is committed to forming strategic partnerships to elevate our organization's credibility and support. Through partnering with well-known and trusted organizations, we aim to increase our visibility and improve the public perception of our brand. These partnerships will enhance efficiency in our work and leverage the available resources for improved service delivery.

Strategic Objective: To strengthen The Malkia Initiative's profile and reputation to attract and sustain strategic partners through effective communication and visibility by 2029.

Strategic Area	Strategies/Initiatives	Expected Change(Out-comes)	Activities/Tasks	Cost Estimate (USD)	Timeline	Responsible
Strategic Partnerships for organizational growth	Enhanced Communication and Visibility	Strengthened partnerships between The Malkia Initiative and other key stakeholders.	✓ Develop a strategy to leverage partnership opportunities with like-minded partners ✓ Enter new formal partnerships and formalize existing ones ✓ Develop and publish a calendar of events to enhance the active engagement of interested partners ✓ Establish structures to be a key implementing partners in our areas of focus ✓ Develop and implement a communication and branding plan	75,000	2025 2025 Ongoing basis 2025/26 2025	ICT & Communication Manager
Sub Total				75,000		

3.1.4 Strategic Area 4: Organizational Growth and Sustainability

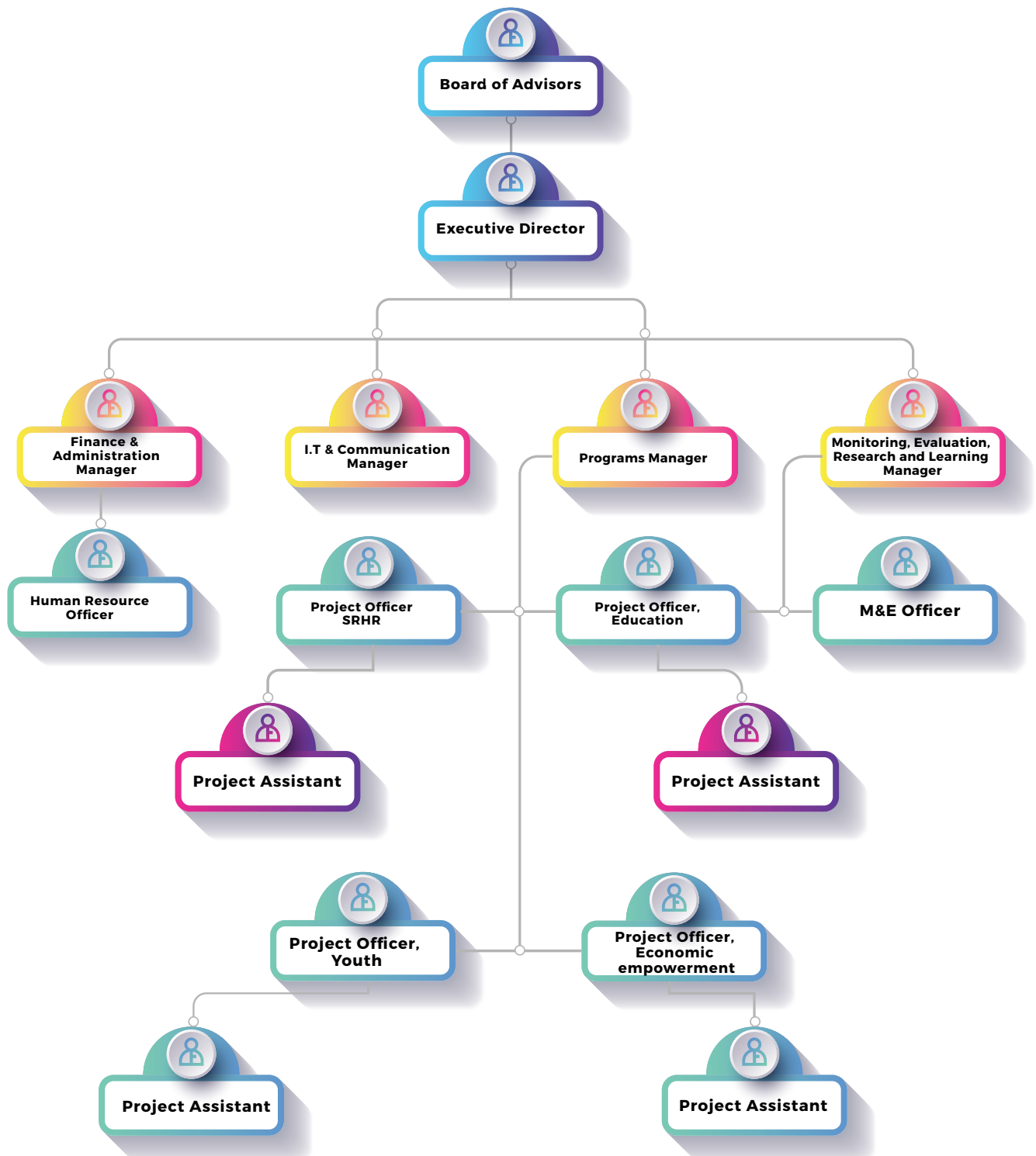
The Malkia Initiative is committed towards “Catalyzing community change to amplify the agency, voice, and choice for every adolescent Girl and Youth.” To fulfill this Mission, The Malkia Initiative intends to strengthen its organizational capacity by developing and implementing guiding policies and procedures that promote accountability and transparency. In addition, The Malkia Initiative will also strengthen its existing systems and structures for the growth and sustainability of the organization.

Strategic Objective: To enhance The Malkia Initiative’s effectiveness and efficiency to deliver on its Mission by strengthening the internal systems and structures by 2029.

Strategic Area	Strategies/Initiatives	Expected Change (Outcomes)	Activities/Tasks	Cost Estimate (USD)	Timeline	Responsible
Organizational Growth and Sustainability	Capacity Strengthening for Board Members	Effective and efficient team and organizational processes for sustainability.	✓ Conduct quarterly board meetings ✓ Organize annual retreat for Board Members and Management team	50,000	Quarterly Annually	Board Chair
	Capacity Strengthening for management team and staff	Well-capacitated team for efficient and effective delivery of their roles	✓ Conduct governance training for the Management team ✓ Organize annual retreat for the Management team and staff ✓ Conduct security training for the staff and interns ✓ Conduct training on inclusion for persons with disability ✓ Conduct training on Fundraising skills on proposal writing and concept notes ✓ Conduct quarterly review meetings ✓ Conduct monthly review meetings	30,000	2025 Annually Quarterly	Executive Director
Sub Total				80,000		
	Streamlining organizational systems and structures	Strong organizational systems	✓ Identify and engage a consultant to provide technical assistance ✓ Conduct a mid-term review and final evaluation of SP in 2026 and 2029 respectively ✓ Develop and implement a Memorandum of Understanding document for The Malkia Initiative ✓ Strengthen the financial and HR systems	20,000	Annually 2025, 2029 2026	
	Resource Mobilization	Increase in sustainable resources	✓ Develop and implement a resource mobilization strategy ✓ Organizing resource mobilization activities and proposal/ grant writing ✓ Identify local corporates and collaborate/target their CSR for amplified outcomes in the community	125,000	2025 Quarterly Annually	Executive Director
Sub Total				145,000		
Grand Total				2,000,000		

THE MALKIA INITIATIVE'S ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

4.1 ORGANOGRAM 2025 – 2029



4.2 Role of Key Positions in the SP Implementation

The following will be the roles of the different positions in the implementation of the strategic plan.

The Board

Board Members are responsible for reviewing the strategy and tracking its implementation, guiding institutional governance, approving annual work plans and budgets, and fundraising support. Its chairperson will convene its meetings and provide guidance for its deliberations. The Board will meet at least once every quarter to review the organization's progress and approve the funding of projects. Where necessary, meetings will be convened more frequently. Key decisions anticipated each year include:

- A review of annual plans prepared by the Malkia Initiative team, with their associated outputs, targets, and budget allocation.
- A review of the funding base and sources for increased funding.
- Review and adoption of quarterly and annual progress reports.
- Convene key stakeholder forums.

The Executive Director

The Executive Director will provide strategic direction for the institution and shall be responsible for overall management. He or she will ensure that The Malkia Initiative is achieving its objectives and set targets. The National Coordinator will be responsible for the day-to-day management of all aspects of the institution. In addition, this office will be responsible for spearheading The Malkia Initiative's fundraising strategy and the development and maintenance of strategic partnerships.

Program Managers

The managers of the different thematic areas and the technical teams will lead the thematic teams in the implementation of the strategy. The management of each thematic team will reflect the need to achieve team-specific goals as well as the interdependence of all four thematic areas. This will also include individual and team planning on monitoring and evaluation. Other program team members will be assigned tasks with a view toward supporting mentorship. Every staff member will operate in a manner that ensures adequate investment of time and delivery of quality products.

The Finance and Administrative Support Team

Finance and administrative support team will ensure that The Malkia Initiative's internal operational frameworks can effectively deliver on this strategy. This team will enhance financial, administrative and logistical support systems to ensure efficiency, transparency and accountability. Administrative services shall be of exemplary quality and will espouse rights-based approaches. The administrative team shall, in consultation with the technical team, develop activities to enhance staff cohesiveness and overall performance.

Monitoring, Evaluation, Research and Learning Manager

The Monitoring, Evaluation, Research, and Learning (MERL) Manager will play a crucial role in strategic plan implementation by tracking progress, assessing outcomes, and ensuring data-driven decision-making. He / she will identify areas for improvement, facilitate learning, and ensure that the organization's goals are met efficiently and effectively, fostering continuous improvement and accountability.

5. MONITORING AND EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

This M&E plan describes the strategic information The Malkia Initiative will gather and use for decision-making that will lead to improved programs and ultimately realize sustainable development goals. This plan is a fundamental document that will hold The Malkia Initiative accountable and tell whether we succeeded or not. In addition to stating how our organization is going to measure what it has achieved, the M&E plan will function as a document for consensus, guide implementation, and preserve institutional memory.

The strategic plan will be monitored quarterly, and a mid-term evaluation will be conducted against the key outcomes in the final matrix. The comprehensive M&E framework informing tracking, evaluation, and reporting will also be used as a guiding tool on how to effectively track progress in the implementation of The Malkia Initiative Strategic Plan. This is aimed at entrenching the practice of evidence-based programming in the organization's processes.

The National Coordinator and management staff will prepare quarterly status reports on the progress of the strategic plan implementation and report to the Board Members.

The progress reports will highlight major activities undertaken, outputs, challenges, and proposals to resolve them. Financial reports will indicate the income realized and expenditure against the approved budget and reasons for variances.

5.1 Key Performance Indicators

This section lists the key performance indicators which are measurable values that shall help The Malkia Initiative to track the SP 2025-2029 progress towards achieving the set strategic objectives. Its providing a clear and objective way to monitor performance, identify areas for improvement, and make informed decisions.

Below are key KPI the SP will be monitored against:

- Improved access & uptake of SRHR services
- Retention and increase of adolescent girls in schools
- Quality adolescent- girls/ young people-led knowledge generated products influencing advocacy, decision-making, and policy development at national, regional and global levels.
- Strengthened Partnerships & relationships.
- Effective and efficient teams and organizational processes for sustainability.
- Well-capacitated team for efficient and effective delivery of their roles
- Strong organizational systems in place
- Market share growth
- Customer retention

5.2 Key Elements for Evaluation of this Strategic Plan

The Malkia Initiative shall undertake a midterm evaluation in mid 2027. The evaluation shall be guided by strategies and activities reflected in the strategy implementation plan.

The following shall constitute the major aspects of evaluation for The Malkia Initiative:

Effectiveness of programs of The Malkia Initiative in meeting the goal and strategic objectives.

- Efficiency in attaining the objectives/targets, in terms of cost-effectiveness.
- Validity, relevance, and coherence of designs of programs.
- Sustainability of programs and lessons learned

6. FUNDRAISING PLAN

2025-2029

Synopsis

This fundraising plan outlines the strategies The Malkia Initiative will implement over the next five years (2025-2029) to secure funding. This is anchored on an ambitious Strategic Plan financial target of Two million USD over the five years. Since its inception, the Malkia Initiative has primarily relied on conventional fundraising methods. However, changes in the funding landscape, including technological advancements, shifts in donor priorities, and evolving global policies, necessitate the adoption of innovative and proactive approaches. To power our Vision: A crown for every African Girl and Mission: To catalyze community, change to amplify the Agency, Voice, and Choice of adolescent girls and Youth; we have developed an ambitious fundraising goal as follows

Justification

This Fundraising plan is well-crafted to provide a pathway the sustainability and growth of The Malkia Initiative. It provides a clear roadmap for achieving our financial goals, enabling the organization to strategically allocate resources, engage donors effectively, and measure progress. By outlining specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound (SMART) goals, the fundraising plan shall help us to focus efforts on the most impactful activities, thereby maximizing the return on investment. Additionally, it fosters accountability and transparency, which are crucial for building trust with stakeholders and securing long-term support

Our fundraising goals

1. Total Funding required for the delivery of the Strategy Plan is \$2,000,000.
2. Short-Term Goals: raising at least \$200,000 within the next 12 months (2025).
3. Long-Term Goals: securing at least:
 - i. **\$ 300,000** in 2026
 - ii. **\$ 400,000** in 2027
 - iii. **\$ 500,000** in 2028
 - iv. **\$ 600,000** in 2029

Our target donors

We envisage to engage the following donors in the 5 years to increase our revenue growth and boost sustainability.

1. Multilateral donors- UNFPA, UNICEF, UN WOMEN, World Bank
2. Bilateral Donors- EU, SIDA, GAC, DANIDA, FCDO, NORAD, AFD, KOICA, GIZ, USAID, CIDA
3. Foundations- Safaricom Foundation, BMGF, Ford Foundations, ABSA Foundation, KCB Foundation, Hewllet Foundation etc
4. International NGOS/ National NGOs- AMREF, HIVOS, Plan International, ForumCIV, Amplify Change, Amplify Girls, Pivotal Ventures, WomenWin, Numum Fund, Child Fund, ACORD, Lions International, FEMNET, Akina Mama Wa Afrika etc
5. High Net worth Individuals- Mackenzie Scott, French Gates, Manu Chandaria
6. Embassies- EKN, Swedish, Canadian High Commission, Danish, French, Belgium, Germany, Irish, Australian, Finnish, Swiss Embassy etc
7. Donations- Online and offline, targeted appeals
8. Individual Giving- Donations from individuals to support specific course using passionate appeals.
9. Gifts- Personalized appeals to encourage gifting of our beneficiaries

Our Fundraising plan

Fundraising Strategy	Activity	Description	Timelines	Responsible
Individual Giving	Annual Giving Campaign	Launch an annual giving campaign with a clear theme and specific fundraising goals to drive support and engagement	Annual	Resource Mobilization officer (RM)
	Monthly Giving Program	Encourage supporters to sign up for monthly donations, providing a steady stream of funding for our ongoing programs	Monthly	RM
	Major Gifts	Identify and build relationships with potential major donors who can make significant contributions to our Mission	Quarterly	RM
	Legacy Giving	Promote planned giving options, such as bequests and endowments, to secure long-term support for the Malkia Initiative	Annual	RM
Fundrasing Events	Gala Events	Host an annual fundraising gala featuring auctions, entertainment, and inspiring guest speakers to raise significant funds and celebrate our achievements	Annual	Comms, ED
	Community Events	Organize local events such as fun runs, charity dinners, and cultural festivals to engage the community and raise funds	Bi-annual	Programs
	Virtual Events	Utilize online platforms to host webinars, virtual concerts, and other engaging virtual events to reach a wider audience and gather support	Quarterly	ED, Communication Officer, Programs

Fundraising Strategy	Activity	Description	Timelines	Responsible
Corporate Partnerships	Sponsorship Packages	Develop tiered sponsorship packages for businesses, offering various levels of visibility and recognition in exchange for their support	Bi-annual	Communication Officer
	Course Marketing	Partner with businesses to donate a percentage of profits to the Malkia Initiative, aligning their brand with our Mission	Annually	ED
Grants	Grant Research	The Malkia Initiative will identify and prioritize grant opportunities from foundations and government sources that align with our programs and objectives	Quarterly	
	Grant Writing	We will develop compelling grant proposals to secure funding, presenting a strong case for the support of our initiatives	Case by case	ED/ RM Consultant
	Reporting and Stewardship	The Malkia Initiative will maintain ongoing relationships with grant makers by providing timely reports and updates on the impact of their contributions	Monthly, Quarterly, Bi-annually, Annually	MEARL Manager
Digital Fund-raising	Crowdfunding Campaigns	Use crowdfunding platforms to fund specific projects and engage a broad audience in our Mission	Case by Case	RM
	Email Campaigns	Develop targeted email campaigns to reach supporters, share updates, and solicit donations	Quarterly	Communication officer
	Social media	Leverage social media to share stories, provide updates, and make donation appeals, engaging a wide audience and fostering a sense of community	Often	Communication officer
Merchandise Sales	Branded Merchandise	The Malkia Initiative will sell branded items such as t-shirts, mugs, and tote bags to raise funds and increase awareness of The Malkia Initiative. We will also feature unique Maasai beaded items, such as jewelry and decorative pieces, which also highlights and promotes traditional craftsmanship	Often	Communication officer
	Online Store	Set up an online store on The Malkia Initiative website to make our merchandise easily accessible to supporters globally. This will provide a convenient way for supporters to purchase items and raise additional funds	Year one	Communication officer
Pro-active Fundraising	Donor Engagement	Engage select donors through pitches to ensure repeat deals, new deals or spin-offs	Case by Case	ED, RM
	Invite donors to our events/ project activities	Using our project activities and other organizational events, invite select donors to grace them	Case by Case	ED, RM, Programs
	Participate in donor events and conferences [national and international]	Identify key donor-led events [virtual or in-person] and conference where our target donors would participate and plan meet ups	Case by Case	ED, RM, Programs
Donor Retention	Active donor engagement; donor participation in project activities; quality and timely reporting; efficiency and effectiveness of project implementation; prudent use of resources	Ensure current donors are retained; ensure repeat funding for the current projects.	Case by Case	ED, Programs

Conclusion

In conclusion, this fundraising plan outlines a strategic approach to securing the necessary resources to achieve our organization's goals. By leveraging diverse funding streams, engaging our community, and implementing innovative fundraising techniques, we are confident in our ability to meet and exceed our financial targets. The success of this plan relies on the collective effort of our team, supporters, and stakeholders. Together, we can make a significant impact and drive our Mission forward.

We look forward to your continued support and partnership in this journey.



Malkia Initiative



www.malkiainitiative.org